

NIDHI KATHAYAT

Web Application Security • VAPT • Penetration Testing

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Summary

Cybersecurity practitioner specializing in Web Application Security and VAPT, with hands-on experience identifying and exploiting vulnerabilities including SQL Injection, XSS, IDOR, and CSRF through CTFs and applied labs. Skilled in reconnaissance and manual testing with Burp Suite, and in producing clear, structured vulnerability reports with proof-of-concept documentation. Focused on adopting an attacker's mindset to uncover real-world security flaws.

Experience

Razzify

Sep 2025 – Dec 2025

CTF Developer Intern (Web Security)

- Designed vulnerable web challenges modeled on real-world attack techniques, including SQL Injection, XSS, and IDOR.
- Performed manual testing and exploitation of vulnerabilities across challenge environments to validate difficulty and realism.
- Documented attack methodology and mitigation strategies in structured writeups for challenge participants.
- Simulated real-world web application vulnerabilities for hands-on exploitation, applying an attacker's mindset to analyze how systems can be broken.

Projects

Hazel CLI – AI-Powered Cybersecurity Terminal | [GitHub](#) | Python

- Built an AI-powered terminal assistant for pentesters that intercepts commands, detects dangerous patterns, and auto-suggests the next pentest tool based on scan output (e.g., Nmap → Gobuster).
- Engineered a multi-provider AI fallback system (Groq, Gemini, OpenRouter, Ollama) with typo correction for pentest tools and a rule-based danger detection engine, built with zero heavyweight dependencies.
- Automated generation of structured pentest writeups directly from session history.

Phishing Email Detection System | [GitHub](#) | Python / ML

- Built an ML-based phishing detection system using Scikit-learn, analyzing URL patterns, sender metadata, and email content.
- Tested detection accuracy against common bypass techniques and attack variations to improve robustness.
- Applied feature extraction and behavioral analysis techniques aligned to SOC-level phishing investigation and IOC identification workflows.

Technical Skills

Web Security: OWASP Top 10, SQLi, XSS, IDOR, CSRF, Authentication Bypass, Race Conditions, Privilege Escalation

VAPT: Enumeration, Vulnerability Identification & Exploitation, Manual Testing, Structured PoC Reports, Attack Path Analysis, Active Directory

Tools: Burp Suite, Nmap, Gobuster, Nikto, OWASP ZAP, Wireshark, Metasploit, Hydra, CyberChef, Nessus, BloodHound

Scripting: Python, Bash, JavaScript, SQL, HTML/CSS

Platforms: Kali Linux, Parrot OS, Windows, Docker, Git

Additional: Splunk (Basic), ELK Stack, Suricata, MITRE ATT&CK, CTI 101

Certifications

- Completed:** CBTP (Certified Blue Team Practitioner) – SecOps Group; CNSP – SecOps Group; C3SA – CyberWarFare Lab; CTI 101 – ARCX
- Pursuing:** CEH (Certified Ethical Hacker); CPent (Certified Penetration Testing Professional)

Education

Poornima University, Jaipur

2024 – 2028

B.Tech in Computer Science and Engineering

Achievements

- 5th place nationally at OWASP Hacker's Gambit 2025 CTF (Team GenZCTF)
- Rank 2 at VectorCTF (TryHackMe)
- 27th place (solo) at CyberNeonGen CTF; 26th place (solo) at TryHackMe Industrial CTF
- Top 30 at AceHack 5.0 Hackathon; top 15 among women participants at Shakti CTF (54th overall)